pression, a grainier image than in the raw format, and a blurry or washed out feel to edges, especially apparent while taking images of text.

4.3 TIFF

TIFF stands for Tagged Image File Format, and is somewhere in between JPEG and raw in terms of quality. It is essentially a form of lossless compression. This means that when an image file is stored in the TIFF format, none of the original information is lost. Unlike JPEG, which supports only 8 bits per channel of single-layer RGB images, TIFF supports 16 bits per channel of multi-layer CMYK images. Another advantage of TIFF is that it is compatible with most image editing and viewing programs, and is more compatible than proprietary raw formats. Even PC or Mac is not an issue with TIFF. It is therefore widely used as the final format in the printing and publishing industry.

Most photographers do not shoot in TIFF in an effort to avoid in camera processing of the image. The alternative is to shoot in RAW and then convert to a layered TIFF to obtain a 'Master' to store on your computer. These days many cameras offer the option of shooting in TIFF alongside JPEG, and RAW. However, most offer only 8-bit layered quality due to space constraints. TIFF takes a longer time to write into the camera's memory too, so if you're shooting in TIFF, you can rule out taking several pictures in a row.

Summing it up, TIFF files open in almost any image editor, are largest in size compared to other formats, and they don't have JPG compression artifacts. The time to open the file in the image editor is also typically shorter than when opening a RAW file. Thus, if you are comfortable with the camera settings (e.g. white balance and exposure) and you don't want to do much post-processing, then TIFF is an option (though not a recommended one). Else, raw is better both in terms of image quality and size. TIFF, however, is an excellent format for scanning. It offers 16-bit scanning and these days there are many printers that offer the same quality printing. Back in the days of film, scanning to TIFF was the norm.